

shipermansfriend

Version unspecified

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Status

Version 1.0.0-SNAPSHOT

Supported Platforms

- Android
- Windows
- Linux

About

Shiperman's Friend is a simple to use yet powerful ship spotter centric vessel tracker app. It has no fancy map view or vessel history - there are plenty of apps covering that kind of features. Instead, it focuses on the needs of a ship spotter in the field observing and photographing all the vessels out there.

Thanks

First things first. Many thanks go out to the volunteer team at iostream.io. Without your work to keep this up and running this project would not be possible or even exist!

Features

- Using aisstream.io as it's only data source as this the only service providing AIS livedata for free. It is mandatory to create a free account and obtain an api key (also free).
- Configurable double geo fence. Ship master data and safety messages are collected within the outer bounding box whereas position data is only collected within the inner bounding box. This inner bounding box is treated as the monitoring range of the ship spotter.
- Card view of all moving and moored vessels (separate tabs) in the monitored bounding box which shows the most important infos for a vessel.
- Vessel radar view to orientate in a dense environment which can be filtered by ship category or ship name, mmsi, imo number or callsign.
- Search tab to find and spot vessels of your interest.
- Safety message tab which display all safety relevant messages which have been sent in the outer bounding box.
- Mark/unmark any vessel as photographed (or just for interest). Within the settings tab you can then export the list of all marked vessels as csv file. For this list the time of hitting the mark button is used to have the vessel in order of observation for the later post-processing session at home.
- Export and import of collected ship masterdata so you can collect data overnight on your desktop and use this data on your mobile device.
- Export and import of settings. The API key is treated as a password and is stored encrypted with a platform key.
- To avoid any costs as most ship spotters are hobbyists no commercial data source is used to obtain extra infos like TEUs, etc. Unfortunately there is no free data source for this out there. I also do not want to scrape data out of websites as this would end in a legal mess. Instead, every vessel card has a button which sends you to the vessel page of [myshiptracking](#). As the search parameter the mmsi or imo code is used (if available). I think this is a good compromise and will lead to some extra traffic for that provider.

Downloads

This documentation is also available as [PDF Document](#)

You can obtain the zip file for desktop, the installer package for linux or the apk file for android from the artifacts section on the right side of this page.

Usage

Driving Vessels Tab

The tab shows all vessels currently under way within the inner bounding box.

The top bar shows the coordinates of your current location. When you click on it you are being sent to googlemaps to show the location on a map.

Below you can see the amount of minutes ago of the last location update, the number of vessels in the view and the currently chosen inner radius.

The led on the right shows if messages from aisstream.io are received (light blue) or not (dark/off). When no messages are received for a longer time interval starting with 30 seconds the color will slowly go from orange to pink which tells you that the server is currently offline. In that state a button is shown which allows you to manually try to reconnect.

Under that the vessel cards are shown which contain only the information which can be obtained from aisstream.io. I decided not to scrape other webpages for additional interesting information like tonnage, TEUs etc. Instead, you can click on the middle button on the right to open a browser with the vessels page on <https://www.myshiptracking.com/>. I have chosen this provider as it is the only one which allows to search for mmsi numbers which is mandatory for this project as aisstream only sporadically provides imo numbers for vessels.

When you click on the rightmost icon with the radar icon the radar page is opened with the selected vessel being highlighted with a white flashing circle.

The right big blue section shows an icon for the ships category and a led light with the official category colors used by most of the AIS data providers out there.



Moored Vessels Tab

The tab shows all vessels with a sog (speed over ground) less than 0.5 knots. Those are considered as moored. The overall layout is the same as for the driving vessels tab.



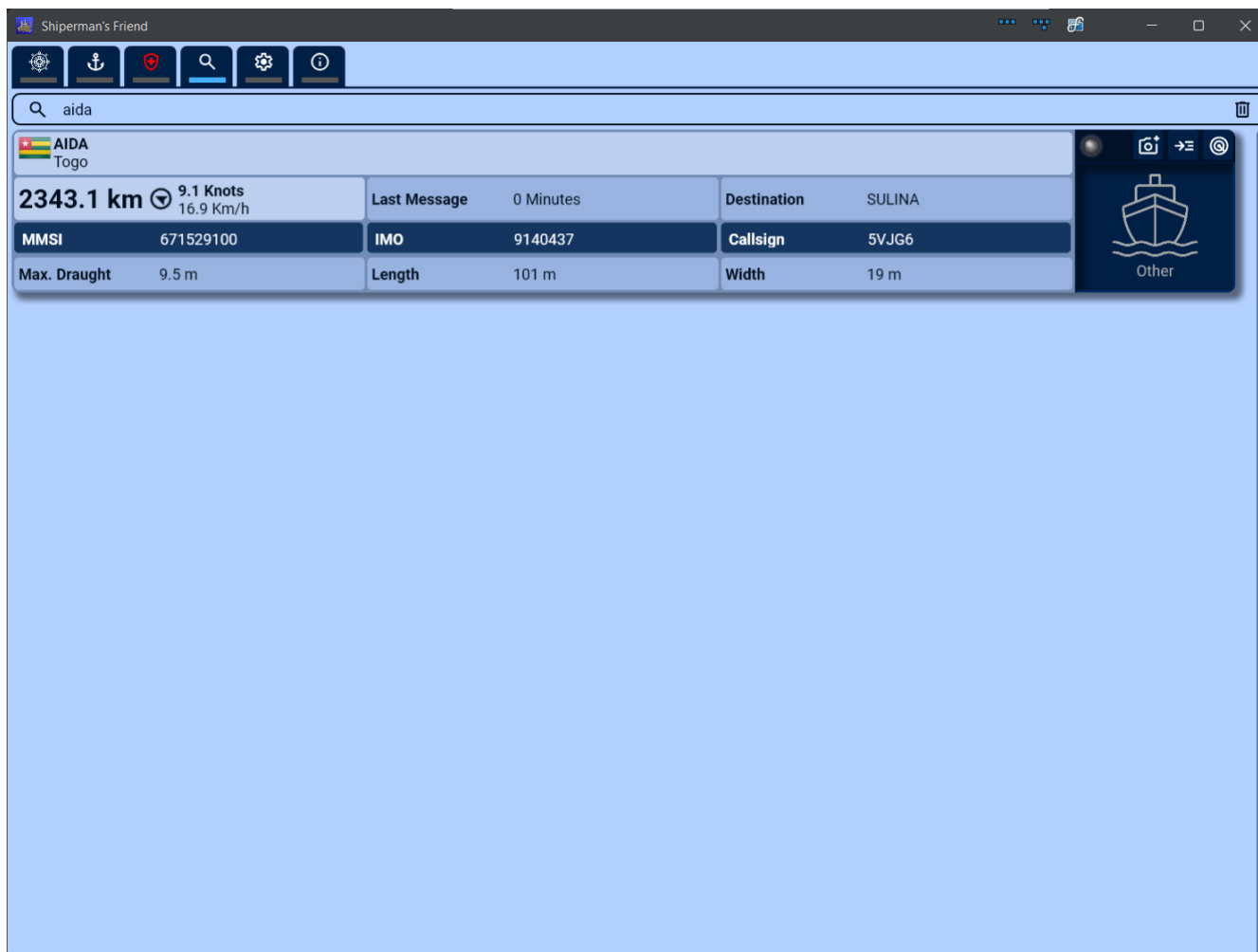
Safety Messages Tab

This tab shows currently active safety messages which have been collected within the outer bounds. Please note that these might not belong to your watched area. From the message text the severity of the message is determined using certain keywords for warnings and alerts. According to the severity the messages are also highlighted in red.



Search Vessels Tab

This tab allows you to search for vessel names, mmsi, imo, callsign, or ship category (english category names only). The overall layout is the same as for the driving vessels tab.



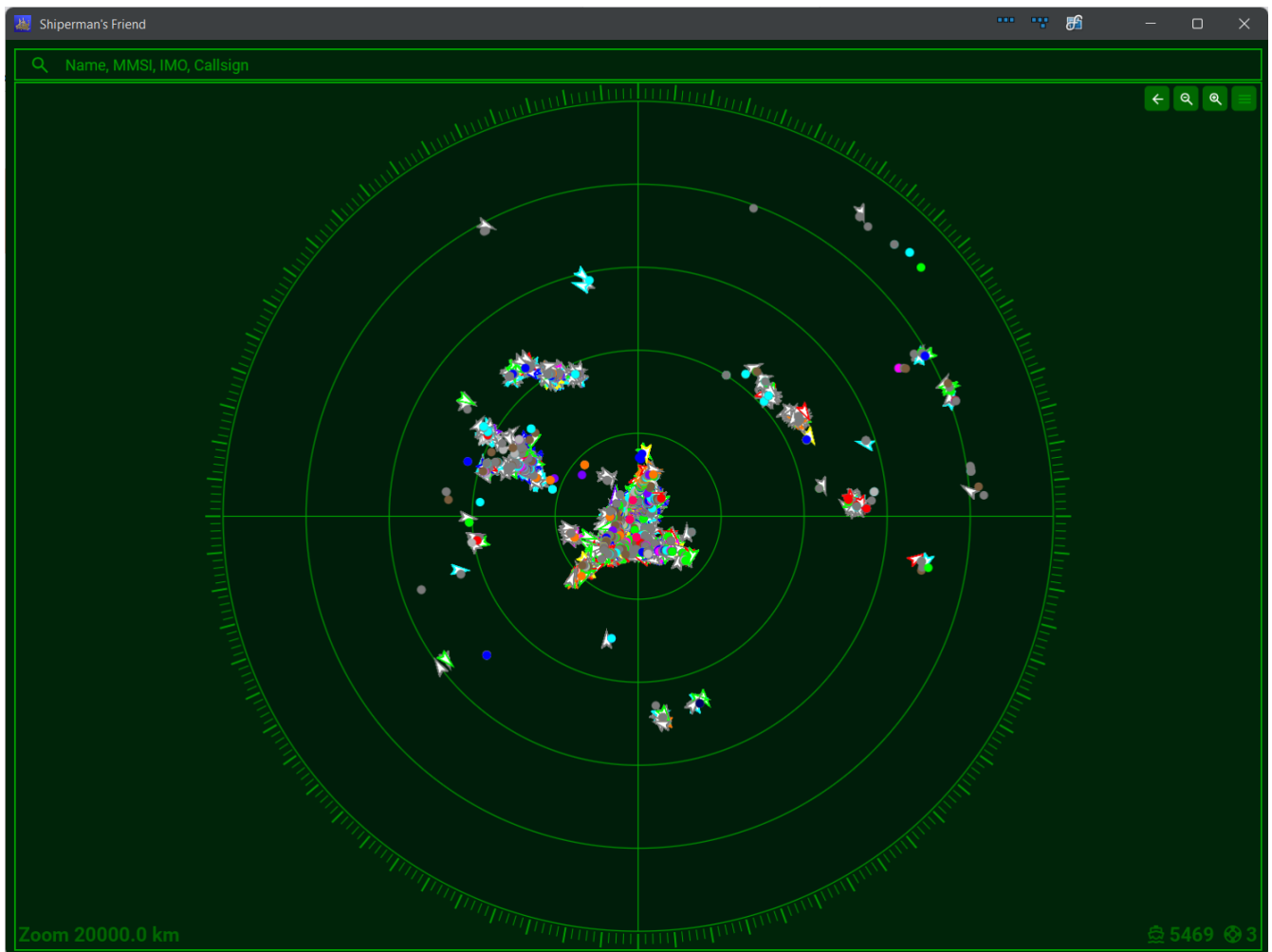
Radar Page

The radar page shows you all vessels within the inner radius to allow you to orientate in a dense spotting environment such as a harbor.

The currently selected vessel (that one where you clicked on the radar button) is highlighted with a white flashing circle. vessels having current safety messages are highlighted with a red flashing circle. Driving vessels are depicted with an arrow showing the current heading and moored vessels are displayed as a small circle by default (when the vessel is big enough its size as reported by AIS data is shown using a rectangle)

You can hover over vessel icons to show all vessel data in short form under the cursor or thumb.

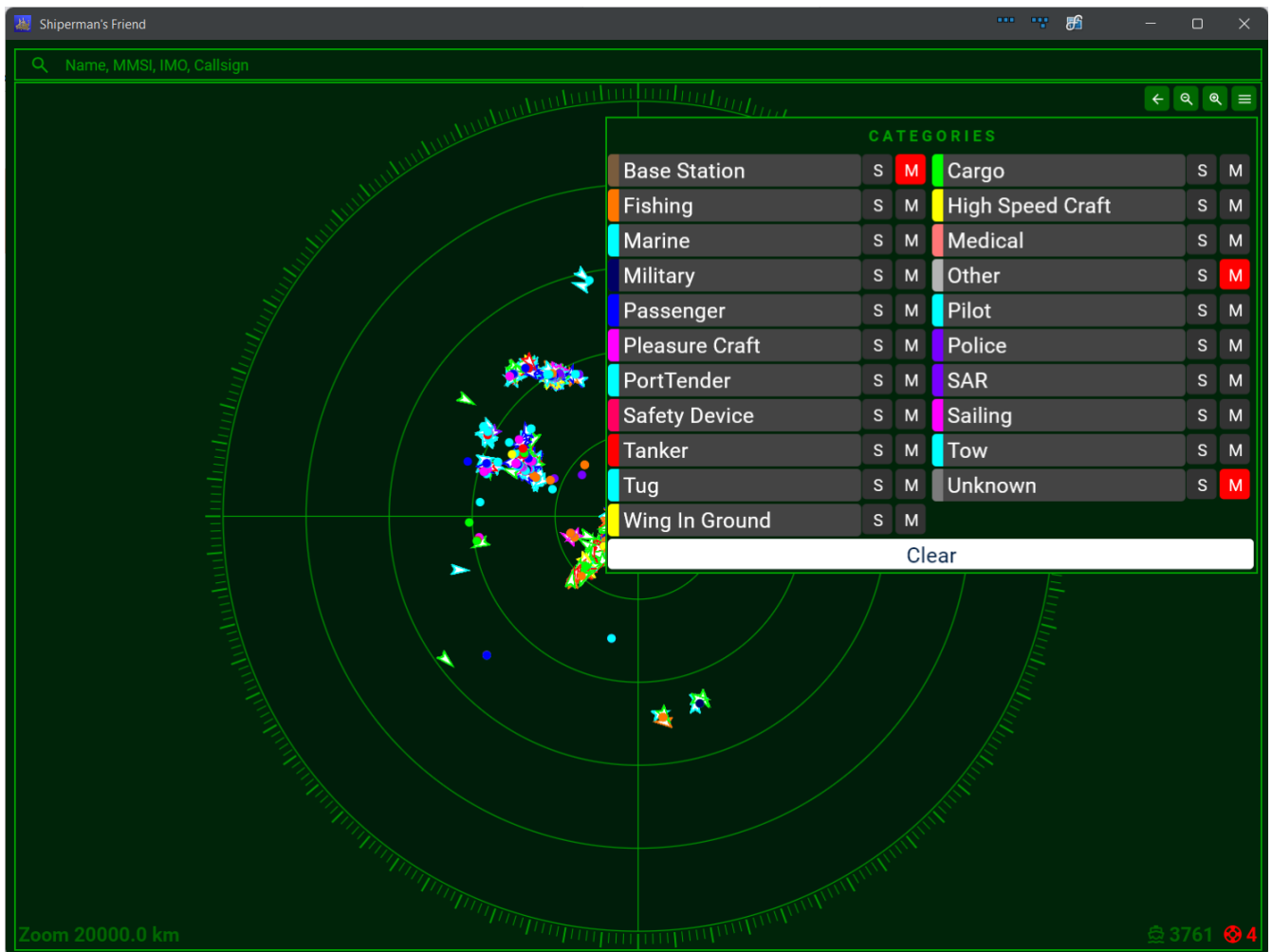
- In the top left corner you see the currently selected vessels name and below it's speed
- In the top right corner you find buttons to zoom in and out and to jump back to the previous view.
- In the bottom left corner the current zoom distance of the radar is shown.
- In the bottom right corner you see counts for visible vessels on the radar and currently active safety messages (those will be colored red when there are unread messages)



The shown vessels can be filtered by clicking on the burger menu on the top right which shows a flyover menu with all the known categories listed with their name, the standard category color and solo and mute buttons. Using the respective solo (S) or mute (M) buttons. You can either solo or mute categories. When you change the mode from solo to mute or vice versa all categories of the respective other mode will be cleared to avoid confusion what is muted or soloed. Use the clear button below to clear all the category selections.

These filters are combined with whatever you have entered in the top search bar.

The ship count in the top bar reflects the number of filtered vessels.



Settings Tab

The basic settings tab where you can set the outer and inner radius around the current location (when use gps location is switched on), or the entered coordinates as a fallback. The coordinates can be entered either as double values or in DMS notation. The radius can be entered either as double (not dot or fraction needed) or with either m (meters) or km (kilometers) unit. You can switch on and off "use gps location" during your session. The location will then be updated and used as the new centerpoint for your outer and inner bounding boxes. To obtain an API key for aisstream.io (which is currently the one and only free of charge open data source for AIS data) you have to register on their [website](#) and create an API key.

Shiperman's Friend



Settings

⬇ Settings

⬆ Settings

⬇ Masterdata

⬆ Masterdata

⬆ Photo Prot...

Language

English

AIS Stream

AIS Stream API Key

.....

👁

Current Location

53.545977 9.9680454

Use GPS location instead of fix location

☐

Outer Radius

2000km

Inner Radius

1000km

✕

✓

14

Legal

License

[GNU GENERAL PUBLIC LICENSE v3 \(2007\)](#)

This project is licensed under GPLv3. If you use this code in your app, your entire app must also be open-sourced under GPLv3.

What this means for you

You are free to use, modify, and distribute this software.

Copyleft

If you use this code in your own project or app, your entire project must also be licensed under GPLv3 and its source code must be made public. This effectively prevents using this code in "closed-source" commercial apps. If you intend to sell an app based on this code without releasing your source code, you are in violation of this license. Of course, you can always for a commercial license.

Attribution

Vessel Icons are taken from [Freepik - Flaticon](#)

Note

The banner was created by myself using Adobes Firefly AI engine which guarantees commercial compatibility. I did not use any original artwork of the well known suits company and researched that the Font used for the brand is indeed just Gill Sans which is available for free download in the internet. So no harm done here.